

MANASHI RAY

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

2011–Present	Professor of Sociology Department of Psychology and Sociology West Virginia State University
2010–2011	Visiting Assistant Professor Department of Sociology, Anthropology and Social Work Central Michigan University
2009–2010	Adjunct Faculty Department of Sociology Saginaw Valley State University

EDUCATION

2010	PhD, Sociology, Michigan State University
2000	Executive Development Program, Globalization and Liberalization: Challenges for NGOs Indian Institute of Management, Bangalore, India
1992–1993	Post-Graduate Diploma in Population and Sustainable Development International Institute of Social Studies, The Hague, The Netherlands
1991–1992	Post-Graduate Certificate in Research Methodology Tata Institute of Social Sciences, Bombay, India
1979–1981	M.A. Sociology Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda, Baroda, India
1976–1979	B.A. Sociology University of Poona, Pune, India

Areas of Expertise: International migration, transnationalism, network analysis, social stratification, inequality and mobility, gender and South Asia

PUBLICATIONS

Books

2026 *Becoming Boundless: Indian Transnational Entrepreneurs in the Global Economy*
(Stanford University Press), <https://www.sup.org/books/sociology/becoming-boundless?tab=reviews>.

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles and Book Chapters

- 2019 "Experiences of Empowerment and Constraint: Narratives of Transnational Indian Women Entrepreneurs," in *Routledge Handbook of Indian Transnationalism*, edited by Ajaya Sahoo and Bandana Purkayastha.
- 2017 "Crossing Borders: Family Migration Strategies and Routes from Burma to the US," *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*, Vol 44, Issue No. 5, p. 773-791, DOI 10.1080/1369183X.2017.1314815.
- 2013 "The Global Circulation of Skill and Capital – Pathways of Return Migration of Indian Entrepreneurs from the United States to India," in *Diaspora Engagement and Development in South Asia*, edited by Tan Tai Yong and Md Mizanur Rahman, Palgrave Macmillan. p. 75-102.2008 "Poverty Eradication – South Asia's Burdens: A Question of Urgent Redressal" (with Shobha Raghuram), in *Does Culture Make A Difference? Progress and Development in India and Its Implications for International Cooperation*, edited by Martin Wade, Calcutta, Seagull Books.
- 1999 "The State and Civil Society: Meeting Health Needs, Reaching Equity" (with Shobha Raghuram), *Development*, Vol. 42, No. 4, p. 54-85.
- 1995 "The Economics of Population and Development," *Economic and Political Weekly* (Special Article; September 9), Vol. XXX, p. 2263-2269. Reprinted in *Population Index*, Vol. 62, No. 2, Princeton University Library.

Manuscript in Progress

Journal Article : "Imaginable Futures : Indian Women's Entrepreneurship in Transnational Space."

Encyclopedia Entry

- 2012 "Brain Drain," in *Encyclopedia of Globalization*, edited by George Ritzer, Oxford, Wiley-Blackwell, DOI: 10.1002/9780470670590.wbeog053.

Publications: Other (Book Reviews, Reports, Working Papers, Newspaper Articles)

- 2013 Book Review of *The Immigration and Settlement of Asian Indians in Phoenix, Arizona 1965-2011: Ethnic Pride vs. Racial Discrimination in the Suburbs* by Emily Skop, *Asia and Pacific Migration Journal*, Vol. 22, No. 4, p. 573-76.
- 2003 (with Shobha Raghuram) "The Necessity for Compulsory School Education in Social Development - An Overview," *Hivos Monograph*.
- 2000 (with Shobha Raghuram) "The State and Civil Society: Meeting Health Needs, Reaching Equity," *Hivos Technical Report Series* 1.8.
- 1995 "Shifting the Population Policy: From Numbers to People," *The Economic Times*, Publication of the Times Group, India, August 20, 1995.
- 1995 "Women Managers in the Rural Sector," *IRMA Working Paper*, WP-88, Institute of Rural Management, Anand, India.
- 1993 "Characteristics of Growth of the Urban Population in India during 1981-1991," Institute of Social Studies, The Hague, The Netherlands.

- 1992 "Effectiveness of Adult Education Program among Women Learners in West Bengal," Tata Institute of Social Sciences, Bombay, India.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2024 *Defying the Odds: Indian Women's Entrepreneurship in Transnational Space*, Contemporary South Asia Mini Conference, Eastern Sociological Society Conference, Washington, DC, Feb. 29-Mar 3.
- 2023 *Social Mobility in Transnational Spaces: Subjective Perceptions of Indian Women Entrepreneurs*, session "Social and Spatial Mobility: New Entanglements of Class and Migration," XX ISA World Congress of Sociology, Melbourne, Australia, June 25-July 1.
- To Flee or Not to Flee? Im/Mobility Among Ukrainian Glass Artists and Entrepreneurs*, session "The Social Economy of Migrant Labor: Improving Social Protections to End Exploitation," XX ISA World Congress of Sociology, Melbourne, Australia, June 25-July 1.
- 2021 *Ambiguities and Complexities of Selective Adaptation Among Transnational Indian American Entrepreneurs*, session "Diversification in Migrant (Non)adaptation," IV ISA Forum of Sociology, Porto Alegre, Brazil, Feb. 23-27.
- Not to be 'Outpaced' Nor 'Underestimated': Transnational Lives of Indian Women Entrepreneurs*, session "Gendered Resistances in Postcolonial and Transnational Context," IV ISA Forum of Sociology, Porto Alegre, Brazil, Feb. 23-27.
- 2018 *Reproducing Inequalities or Promoting Upward Mobility? A Case of Transnational Asian-Indian Entrepreneurs*, session "International Mobility and Social Stratification," ISA World Congress of Sociology, Toronto, Canada, July 15-21.
- 2016 *What We Eat Makes Us Who We Are! The Food Practices and Transnational Identity of Burmese Refugee Families in Battle Creek, Michigan*, Food in Social Life: Mini Conference on Sociology of Food, Eastern Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Boston, Mar. 17-20.
- 2014 *Navigating the Myanmar–Thailand–Malaysia Border: The Escape Strategies of Burmese Refugees from Chin State, Myanmar, to Battle Creek, Michigan*, XVIII ISA World Congress of Sociology, Yokohama, Japan, July 13-19.
- 2012 *The Latent Power of Networks: The Routes of Re-migration of Returnee Entrepreneurs from the United States to India in the 21st Century*, Invited Workshop Participant at "Diaspora and Development: South Asian Diaspora Engagement in South Asia," Institute of South Asian Studies (ISAS), National University of Singapore, Singapore, Sept. 27-28.
- How Did I Get Here? The Cultural and Social Moorings of Business Behavior among Asian Indian Women Entrepreneurs in the 21st Century*, panel "Work/Life Balance," Eastern Sociological Association Annual Meeting, New York, Feb. 23-26.
- 2011 *A Balancing Act! The World of Transnational Indian Women Entrepreneurs*, panel "South Asian American Female Consumptions," Asian American Studies Annual Conference, New Orleans, May 18-21.
- Is Accessing Global Markets Easier than Ever in the 21st Century? A Comparative Study of U.S.-based Returnee and Non-migrant Transnational Indian Entrepreneurs in India*, panel "Highly Skilled Migration in the 21st. Century," Eastern Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, Feb. 24-27.
- 2010 *Transcending National Borders for Global Markets: A Comparison of Immigrant and non-migrant Transnational Indian Entrepreneurs in High Tech and Consumer Goods Sectors*, panel

“Transnational Entrepreneurs: Old and New,” 22nd Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, June 24-26.

Negotiating Identity as ‘Transnationals: The Contextual Intersection of Multi-State Membership and Identity among the Immigrant and Returnee Entrepreneurs in the U.S. and India, panel “Religion and Ethnicity in India,” 38th National Association for Ethnic Studies Annual Conference, Washington, DC, April 8-10.

- 2008 *I Can Talk Baseball with an Average American and Cricket with an Indian! The Construction of Symbolic Identity by Professional Asian Indian Immigrants in the United States*, Asian American Studies Annual Conference, Chicago, April 16-20.

Invited Talks

- 2020 Discussant, plenary session, *Migration and the Politics of Borders*, Sociologist for Women in Society (winter meeting), San Diego, Feb. 1.
- 2019 *The Disruptors - Returnee Transnational Entrepreneurs in India*, organized by Diaspora, International Migration Program (CAS) and Organization for Diaspora Initiatives (ODI), Jawaharlal Nehru Institute of Advanced Study, Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi, Mar 12.
- The Disruptors - Returnee Transnational Entrepreneurs in India and Escaping Gender Roles or Seeking Compromise? Changing the Narrative of Womenpreneurs*, organized by UGC Center for the Study of Indian Diaspora and Center for Women’s Study, University of Hyderabad, Hyderabad, India, Jan. 29-30.
- 2017 *Migration of Chin-Refugees from their Homeland to the US*, St. Xavier’s College, Kolkata, India, July 13.
- 2009 *Social and Human Capital at Work - A Case of Transnational Asian Indian Entrepreneurs in the Global Economy*, Asian Studies Center, Michigan State University, East Lansing, Mar. 26.
- 2008 *Rethinking Identity in Transnational Spaces*, Global Urban Studies Program Workshop, Michigan State University, East Lansing, Nov. 25.
- 2004 *The Role of Women’s Rights and Empowerment in Global Economic Development*, United Nations Day, 59th Year Anniversary Celebration, Michigan State University International Center, East Lansing, Oct. 24.

RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS in INDIA

- 1999–2000 **Research Consultant**, Humanistic Institute for Co-operation with Developing Countries (Hivos), Bangalore, India
- 1998–1999 **Research Consultant**, Action Aid’s Asia Regional Office. Bangalore, India
Project Title: ‘Impact of Globalization and Liberal Policies on Poverty Issues in India’
- 1996–1997 **Research Coordinator**, Action Aid’s India Office, Bangalore, India
- 1995–1996 **Research Consultant**, M.S. Swaminathan Research Foundation, Chennai, India

Project Title: “Gender Issues in Local Governance”: preparation of training modules for enabling women and men members of elected village panchayats to prepare socio-demographic charters for their respective villages

- 1994–1995 **Visiting Fellow**, Institute of Rural Management, Anand, Gujarat, India
- 1987–1991 **Research Officer**, Lutheran World Service (India), Kolkata, India. Responsibilities: Coordination of planning, research, evaluation and monitoring of social development projects in India

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS & GRANTS

- 2019 Fellowship at the Jawaharlal Nehru Institute of Advanced Study, Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi
- 2017–2018 Promoting Excellence in Education through Research (PEER) Grant, West Virginia State University, for book project: Becoming Boundless: Indian Transnational Indian Entrepreneurs in the Global Economy
- 2019–2020 State University, for book project: Becoming Boundless: Indian Transnational Indian Entrepreneurs in the Global Economy
- 2021–2022 Entrepreneurs in the Global Economy
- 2012–2013 Travel Grant from RC 31 Research Committee, International Sociological Association
- 2011–2015 Faculty Research and Development Fund, West Virginia State University
- 2008–2009 The S. C. Lee Best Graduate Paper Award, Asian Studies Center, Michigan State University
- 2008–2009 Dissertation Completion Award, College of Social Science, Michigan State University
- 2007–2008 The Jay Artis Endowment Fund for Graduate Studies in Sociology
- 2007–2008 Graduate Student Research Enhancement Award, Graduate School, Michigan State University
- 2007–2008 Decker-Muns Friendship Memorial Scholarship in recognition of accomplishments, community involvement and perspective on disability by Resource Center for Persons with Disabilities, Michigan State University (also received 2003–2005)
- 2000–2002 Graduate School Fellowship, Recruitment Award, Michigan State University
- 1994–1995 Visiting Scholar Fellowship, Institute of Rural Management, Anand, Gujarat, India
- 1992–1993 Rafael Salas Memorial Scholarship, United Nations Population Fund, in recognition of outstanding academic performance in “Population and Sustainable Development Program”
- 1992–1993 United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA) Fellowship for the Global Training Program in “Population and Sustainable Development,” International Institute of Social Studies, The Hague, The Netherlands

SERVICE

Academic/Professional Service

Member of Editorial Board: *Transnational Mobilities: Interdisciplinary Approaches to Migration Research, Policy, and Practice Across Borders*

- 2027– Program Committee Member, organizing Pre-conference Workshop “Migration and Methods,” RC 31 at the XXI World Congress of Sociology, Gwangju, Korea
- 2023–2027 Treasurer, Secretary, and Member of the Board of Sociology of Migration (RC 31) of International Sociological Association, Program Coordinator of RC 31 for V ISA Forum, Rabat, Morocco
- 2023 Session Organizer, "The Covid-19 Crisis, Gender, and the Price of Migrants 'Invisibility,'" joint session for RC 31 & 32 at XX ISA World Congress of Sociology, Melbourne, Australia, June 25-July 1, 2023
- 2020–2021 Elected member of Nomination Committee, Sociologists for Women in Society
- 2018–2023 Treasurer and Member of the Board of Women, Gender and Society (RC 32), International Sociological Association
- 2019 Invited Panelist for Special Session “Migration and Human Security,” ASA 2019, New York, Aug. 10-13

Invited by the Program Committee of ASA 2019 to organize a panel for Special Session “Immigration and Social Justice,” New York, Aug. 10-13
- 2018 Committee Member for Best Research Paper Award. Asia and Asian American Section of American Sociological Association’s 113th Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, Aug. 11-14

Session Organizer, “Globalization and Gender,” American Sociological Association's 113th Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, Aug. 11-14
- 2018 Session Organizer, “Refugees and Gender: Challenges for Travel, Border-Crossing and Security in the 21st Century,” joint session for RC 31&32, ISA World Congress of Sociology, Toronto, Canada, July 15-21
- 2016 Presider, session “Immigration and Gender,” American Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Seattle, Aug. 21
- 2012–2026 Manuscript Reviewer for the following journals: *Ethnic and Racial Studies*; *Journal of Contemporary Ethnography*; *Journal of Immigrant & Refugee Studies*; *Journal of Urban Affairs*; *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*; *International Sociology*; *Palgrave Communications*; *Canadian Ethnic Studies*; *Journal of Refugee Studies*; *International Migration*; *Contemporary South Asia*; *Transnational Mobilities*
- 2014 Session Organizer, Migration and Gender for RC 31, ISA World Congress of Sociology, Yokohama, Japan, July 13-19

Presider, panel “Racial and Ethnic Identities,” Table 30, Sociologists for Women in Society (Winter Meeting), Nashville, Feb. 6-9
- 2011 Chair and Discussant, Panel “The Consumption of ‘Oriental’ Others in Asian America,” Asian American Studies Annual Conference, New Orleans, May 18-21

Service as Visiting Scholar at Institute of Rural Management, Anand, India

- 1995 Organizer of the professional workshop on “Women Managers in the Rural Sector,” Institute of Rural Management, Mar. 13-14

At West Virginia State University

2017, 2026	Member of Promotion and Tenure Committee (Second Term; Elected Position)
2015–2018	Member of Educational Policy Committee (Elected Position)
2012–2018	Two-term Senator for the College of Business and Social Science, University Senate (Elected Position)
2020–	Member of Retention Committee (Second Term; Elected Positions)
2015	Organized and coordinated a campus visit and public lectures for Dr. Josephine Beoku-Betts, recipient of Sociologist for Women in Society's Feminist Activism Award, 2014-15, for Department of Psychology & Sociology
2012–2015	Program Chair for Sociology, Department of Psychology and Sociology

TEACHING

Graduate Course: Sociology of Organization

Undergraduate Courses: Social Inequality; Sociology of Family; Sociology of Gender; Migrants and Refugees -The American Experience (special topic); Precarity and the Pandemic (special topic); Introduction to Sociology

Online Teaching Proficiency: Moodle and Blackboard

MEMBERSHIP IN PROFESSIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

International Sociological Association (2009–2028)

American Sociological Association (2005–2022)

LANGUAGE PROFICIENCY

Hindi (India): Fluent in speaking, writing and reading

Bangla (India and Bangladesh): Fluent in speaking